Day 38 - South Outlier Loop Trail, Laidlaw, Turnbull, McCarston's Lake, Springwater

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Dufferin Hi-Land section · hike 49 · Mono Centre and Mono Cliffs Provincial Park

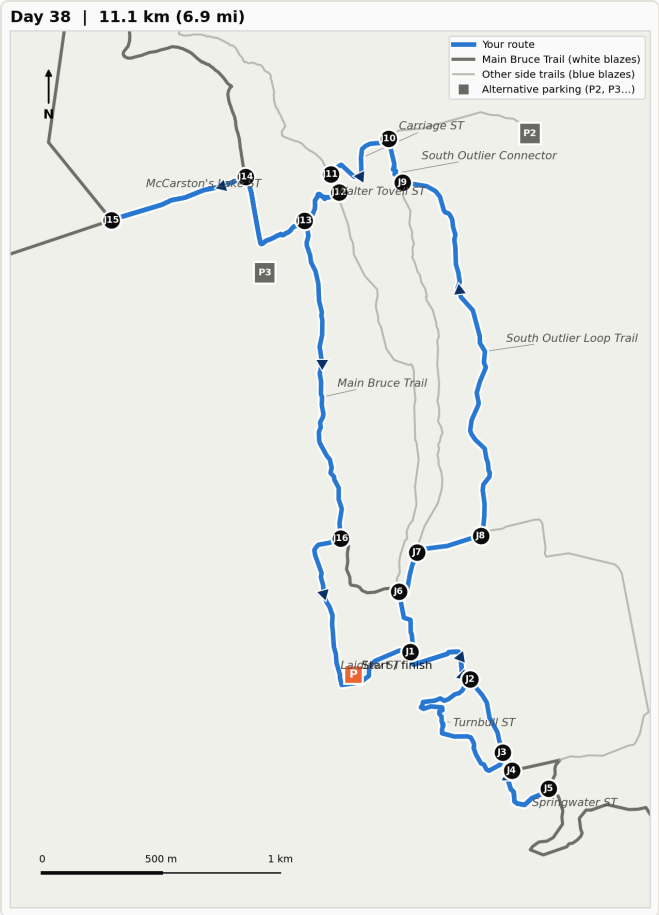
11.1 km / 6.9 mi	~3.4 h	4.9 km new	69 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Mono Community Centre, 200 m south of Mono Centre (County Road 8). Park in gravel lot. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day38_hike049.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: South Outlier Loop Trail (2.0 km); Laidlaw Side Trail (1.1 km); Turnbull Side Trail (0.9 km); McCarston's Lake Side Trail (0.6 km); Springwater Side Trail (0.3 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Gravel lot at the Mono Community Centre, just south of Mono Centre on County Road 8. This is outside the provincial park's pay lot.
- **Laidlaw Side Trail:** Links Mono Centre with the Bruce Trail and includes a stretch on the road shoulder. Keep Zappy close there. No other description of this trail was found.
- **South Outlier Loop:** Starts with a climb up the hill, then levels off on top. The western side follows the cliff edge and has an unofficial lookout facing the cliffs. Stay back from the edge with the dog.
- **Carriage and Walter Tovell trails:** Park trails through shady forest and across an open meadow. The Walter Tovell is a wide, flat path. Expect wooden staircases on the Carriage Trail.
- **McCarston's Lake Side Trail:** A short spur toward McCarston's Lake, a kettle lake left by melting glacial ice.
- **Main Trail and Springwater Side Trail:** One main-trail stretch follows a road shoulder, so keep the leash short there. No details were found for the short Springwater Side Trail.
- **Bugs:** Visitor guides advise bug spray and tick checks. Ontario Parks notes that park trails are not maintained in winter.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Mono Cliffs' Ontario Parks Parking Lot: 3rd Line EHS, 900 metres north of Dufferin Rd 8 map	Paid: $18 per vehicle (full day), $8.50 (4 hours) · book ahead	5.9	620 m	
P3	Limited roadside parking on the 2nd Line EHS north of 20 Sideroad map	Free	6.9	170 m	McCarston's Lake

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 8.1 km / 5.0 mi, covering Laidlaw, South Outlier Loop Trail, Springwater, Turnbull. **Outing 2** from P3 (Limited roadside parking on the 2nd Line EHS north of 20 Sideroad; Free): 7.0 km / 4.3 mi, covering Laidlaw, McCarston's Lake. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Mono Community Centre, 200 m south of Mono Centre (County Road 8). Walk about 50 m to the trail. Head north on the blue-blazed Laidlaw Side Trail.
0.3	0.2	J1: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
0.7	0.4	J2: Junction. Turn right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Turnbull Side Trail goes off on your right.)
1.0	0.6	J3: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Turnbull Side Trail goes off ahead.)
1.1	0.7	J4: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Springwater Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
1.4	0.9	J5: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
1.8	1.1	J4: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
1.9	1.2	J3: Turn sharp left onto the blue-blazed Turnbull Side Trail, heading south. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
2.7	1.7	J2: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-west. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
3.1	2.0	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the Laidlaw Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
3.3	2.0	Heads-up: The next 0.0 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
3.4	2.1	J6: Turn right onto the blue-blazed South Outlier Loop Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left; the blue-blazed Walter Tovell Side Trail goes off ahead.)
3.6	2.3	J7: Junction. Turn right to stay on the South Outlier Loop Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed South Outlier Loop Trail goes off ahead.)
3.9	2.4	J8: Junction. Turn left to stay on the South Outlier Loop Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Whitetail Refuge Side Trail goes off ahead.)
5.6	3.5	J9: Turn right onto the blue-blazed South Outlier Connector, heading north-west. (the blue-blazed South Outlier Loop Trail goes off on your left.)
5.9	3.6	J10: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Carriage Side Trail, heading south-west. (the blue-blazed Carriage Side Trail goes off on your right.)
6.3	3.9	J11: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Walter Tovell Side Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Walter Tovell Side Trail goes off on your right.)
6.4	3.9	J12: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Carriage Side Trail, heading south-west. (the blue-blazed Walter Tovell Side Trail goes off ahead.)
6.6	4.1	J13: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
6.8	4.2	Heads-up: The next 0.3 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
7.1	4.4	J14: Turn left onto the blue-blazed McCarston's Lake Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
7.7	4.8	J15: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
8.3	5.2	J14: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.) The next 0.3 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
8.8	5.5	J13: Junction. Turn right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the Carriage Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
10.2	6.3	J16: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Laidlaw Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
10.3	6.4	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
11.1	6.9	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Parks, Ontario Hiking and the Oak Ridges Trail Association.